CAROS

ROOFING / PRACTICAL GUIDE

Storm Surge Playbook

The 72-Hour Response Plan That Wins Signed Roofs



Illustrative generated scene.

REVENUE FIRST.

Your next storm needs a response plan

It's 4:17 p.m. The phone is in the truck. You're on a roof. Another homeowner needs help.

You paid for that lead. Now someone needs to own the next step.

This playbook helps roofing owners organize the first 72 hours after storm inquiries start arriving. Use it to capture requests, book real inspection slots, and keep estimates moving toward a decision.

The title describes the goal, not a guaranteed result. Weather, roof condition, customer decisions, and crew capacity still matter.

None of these are failures of good roofers. They're failures of process.

Your operating rule: every open inquiry gets one owner, one status, and one dated next action.

Before the next surge, fill this in:

- Response lead: _____
- Backup responder: _____
- Field escalation contact: _____
- Live inspection calendar: _____
- Published service area: _____
- Actual response hours: _____
- Daily inspection capacity, after travel buffers: _____

Revenue first. Start with the path from a ringing phone to a confirmed appointment.

Hours 0–2: Put every inquiry in one queue

Bring calls, website forms, referrals, and messages into a shared record. Check for duplicates before creating another customer.

Record only what you need to respond:

Field	What to capture
Customer	Name, callback number, preferred contact method
Property	Address and service-area fit
Concern	Homeowner's description; don't diagnose remotely
Timing	Inquiry time, response time, next action due
Routing	Owner and backup
Source	Campaign, referral, or other known origin
Permission	Contact preferences and recorded messaging permission
Progress	New, contacted, booked, inspected, estimate, decision

Opening call script

“Thanks for calling [Company]. I'm [Name]. What's happening at the property? Please stay somewhere safe; we don't need you to climb onto the roof. What's the address and best callback number?”

“We can arrange an inspection if you're in our service area. Let me check actual availability before I offer a time.”

Escalation script

“I'm flagging this for [qualified team member]. I can't assess structural or electrical hazards over the phone. If anyone is in immediate danger, contact emergency services.”

Never ask an automated responder to assess roof safety, promise emergency attendance, or decide insurance coverage.

Queue check: no new inquiry should sit without a named owner. If the primary responder is unavailable, send the task to the backup.

Hours 2–6: Acknowledge, then make real contact

An acknowledgment tells the homeowner the message arrived. A conversation establishes what happens next. Track both separately.

Use these templates through your approved messaging setup, with appropriate permission, sending hours, and opt-out handling. Replace every bracket before use. Don't send duplicate texts when someone already answered.

Missed-call acknowledgment

“Hi [First name], this is [Company]. Sorry we missed your call. Are you asking about a roof inspection at [address, if known]? Reply with a good callback time. Our team responds during [hours]. Reply STOP to opt out.”

After-hours acknowledgment

“Thanks for contacting [Company]. Our office reopens at [time/day]. A team member will review your request then. This inbox isn't an emergency service. Reply STOP to opt out.”

Callback opener

“Hi [First name], [Name] at [Company]. You contacted us about [reported concern]. Is now a good time to check the details and discuss inspection availability?”

If there is no answer

“Hi [First name], [Name] from [Company], returning your roofing inquiry. Please call [number] during [hours]. We'll help you work out the next step.”

Set an internal response target your team can meet. Treat five minutes, if you choose it, as your operating target-not an industry conversion guarantee.

Stop rule: a reply pauses the automated sequence and creates a human task. A booking, opt-out, duplicate, or closed request ends the relevant sequence.

Hours 6–24: Book inspections you can actually deliver

Use this inspection-booking flow:

1. Confirm address, service-area fit, and reported concern.
2. Route urgent concerns to a qualified person.
3. Check inspector availability, travel time, and weather restrictions.
4. Offer two available windows.
5. Confirm the homeowner's choice against the live calendar.
6. Create the appointment and assign the inspector.
7. Send confirmation with access instructions and a rescheduling route.
8. If no slot fits, create an owned waitlist task. Don't invent availability.

Booking script

“We currently have [window A] or [window B], subject to safe weather conditions. Which works better? Will we need a gate code or another access arrangement?”

Confirmation text

“[Company]: Your roof inspection is booked for [date/window] at [address]. Inspector: [name]. To change the appointment, call [number] or reply here. Weather may require rescheduling. Reply STOP to opt out.”

Reminder text

“[Company]: A reminder about your inspection on [date/window]. Is access still available? Reply here if plans changed. Reply STOP to opt out.”

Capacity message

“Our next available inspection window is [window]. Would you like that appointment or a callback if an earlier slot opens?”

At the end of the day, compare promises with calendar entries. “We'll get someone out” is not an appointment.

Hours 24–48: Give every inspection an outcome

After the inspection, record findings through your normal professional process. Then record the commercial next step separately.

Choose one outcome: estimate needed, estimate sent, further assessment needed, no work recommended, customer declined, or follow-up requested.

Inspector handoff template

- Customer/property: _____
- Inspection completed: _____
- Findings and supporting records stored at: _____
- Customer question requiring a person: _____
- Estimate owner and due date: _____
- Next customer contact agreed for: _____

Estimate delivery email

Subject: Your roofing estimate and next step

Hi [First name],

Your estimate for [agreed scope] is ready: [secure link]. It explains the proposed work, price, and any listed exclusions.

Would [time A] or [time B] suit a short conversation about your questions?

If your timing has changed, tell us. We'll update the plan rather than keep guessing.

[Name], [Company], [callback details]

Estimate follow-up text

“Hi [First name], [Name] at [Company]. Did the estimate reach you? Happy to explain the scope or arrange a call. Reply STOP to opt out.”

An automated system can deliver and remind. A qualified person should explain scope, answer technical questions, and confirm any revisions.

Hours 48–72: Separate claim steps from sales steps

Insurance-related work needs a visible next action, even when you cannot control the decision date.

Use specific statuses: customer considering claim, inspection documents ready, customer awaiting insurer response, information requested, customer decision pending, or ready for scheduling review.

Avoid using “pending insurance” as a permanent parking space.

Claim coordination record

- Current status and date verified: _____
- Information needed next: _____
- Responsible party: _____
- Roofing team owner: _____
- Customer-approved next check-in: _____
- Document location and access permissions: _____

Customer check-in

“Hi [First name], [Name] at [Company]. Our last note says [verified status]. Has anything changed? We can help locate our inspection documents or explain our estimate. Coverage decisions belong to your insurer.”

Document request email

Subject: Next document for your roofing file

Hi [First name],

To complete [specific contractor task], we still need [specific document]. Please use [approved secure upload method].

If you don't have it, reply and we'll clarify the next step. We won't assume the claim is approved.

[Name]

Send claim questions, disputed amounts, and coverage interpretations to the appropriate qualified person. Keep contractor communications within your team's authorized role.

The owner’s 15-minute queue review

Use 15 minutes as a suggested meeting length. Finish with assignments, not a longer list of mysteries.

Read the queue in this order:

- New inquiries without a substantive response.
- Appointments promised but not booked.
- Completed inspections without an outcome.
- Estimates without a dated next conversation.
- Claim files without a verified status or owner.
- Replies, complaints, and opt-outs requiring action.

Daily scorecard

Measure	Today	Owner/action
Unique inquiries	___	___
Substantive responses within our target / eligible inquiries	___ / ___	___
Confirmed inspections / contacted eligible inquiries	___ / ___	___
Completed inspections / scheduled inspections due	___ / ___	___
Estimates delivered	___	___
Signed contracts, with value tracked separately	___	___
Overdue next actions	___	___

Keep missed calls separate from unique missed opportunities. One homeowner may call three times.

Record lead source through the signed contract. A campaign generating cheap calls can still generate expensive customers.

When automation fails, create a visible exception task. A silent integration failure should not become another silent homeowner.

Do the math, then choose the first fix

Illustrative worksheet-not a forecast or CAROS result

Suppose you have 20 unique, suitable inquiries left unresolved. Assume 50% could become inspections, 20% of those could become signed jobs, and average contract value is $12,000.

20 × 50% × 20% × $12,000 = $24,000 in modeled contract revenue opportunity.

That isn't collected cash, profit, or guaranteed recovery. Some homeowners already hired someone. Others don't need a replacement. Replace every assumption with your records.

Your inputs:

- Unresolved suitable inquiries: ___
- Assumed inspection rate: ___
- Assumed inspection-to-contract rate: ___
- Average contract value: $___
- Modeled opportunity: $___

Choose one workflow to fix before the next storm: missed-call handling, inspection booking, estimate follow-up, or claim status checks.

Test it with a dummy inquiry. Check the owner, calendar, message, reply routing, stop rules, and exception alert.

Automation where it makes sense, humans where they matter.

Measure your leak. Open the CAROS Revenue Leakage Calculator and model your own inputs.

Get a second set of eyes. Request the Free Business Audit to review your response and follow-up process. Find both tools in CAROS Free Resources.